HUSTLE STUDIO · FREELANCER TOOLS

# Freelance Proposal Builder

Guide: write a 1-page summary, offer 3 options, protect your scope.

| Essential | RECOMMENDED Brand Refresh | Complete |
|---|---|---|
| 2,400 | 3,600 | 5,200 |
| deposit 1,200 | deposit 1,800 | deposit 2,600 |

HTML builder · Letter + A4 guide · Templates (MD) · 8 emails · 60 snippets

ⓘ Guidance, not legal advice.

Example figures use fictional clients.

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## How to use this guide

Read Chapters 1 to 3 before your next proposal (about 20 minutes). Use Chapters 4 to 8 when you write the matching section. Chapter 9 shows five finished proposals with notes; Chapter 10 shows six rewrites across five fields. Print Chapter 11 and keep it next to your desk.

Every number in the examples comes from the five presets inside **proposal-builder.html**, so what you read here is what you see when you load a preset. All clients, people and businesses in the examples are fictional.

> ⓘ This guide is practical writing guidance, not legal advice. A proposal is not a contract: once a client says yes, send a short written agreement that suits where you and your client work.

CHAPTER 01

# Start Here

Which file to open first, and a full proposal in five minutes.





## The files

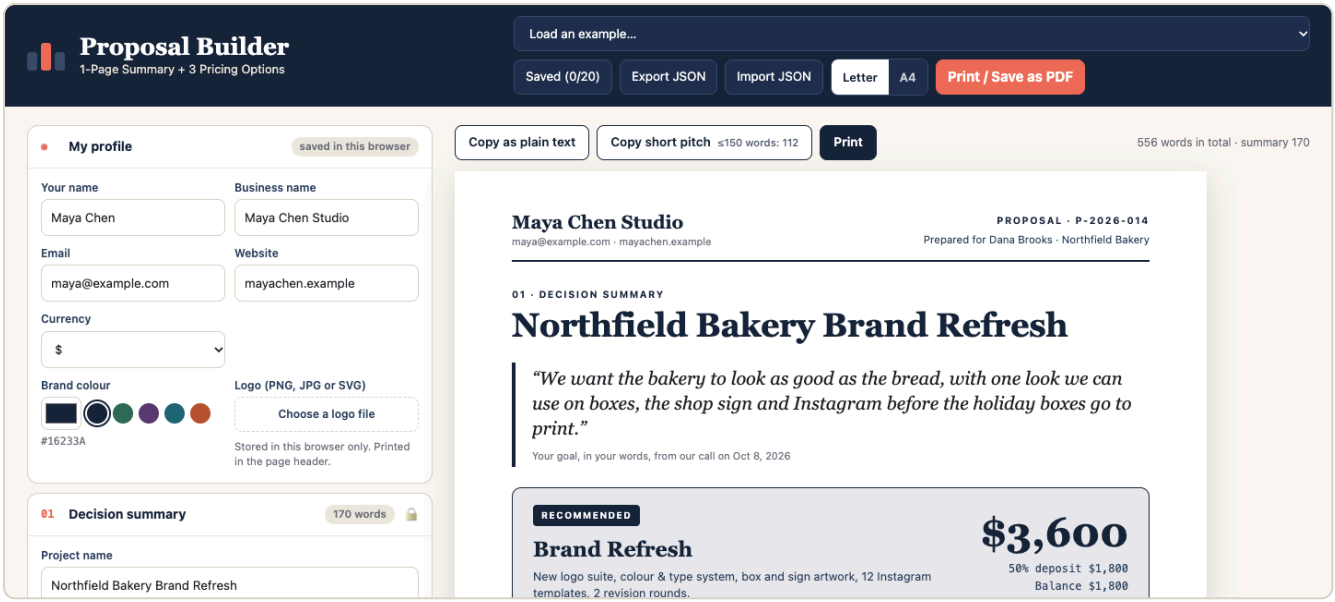
| File | What it is | Open it when |
|---|---|---|
| `proposal-builder.html` | The builder. Works offline in any modern browser. | First. Every proposal starts here. |
| `proposal-guide-letter.pdf` · `proposal-guide-a4.pdf` | This guide, US Letter and A4. | Before and while you write, or to print. |
| `proposal-guide.epub` | The same guide as an e-book. | To read on a phone, tablet or e-reader. |
| `proposal-templates.md` | Blank 9-section template, 5 examples, 60 snippets. | If you prefer Google Docs, Word or Notion. |
| `follow-up-emails.txt` | The 8 follow-up emails. | After you send. |
| `README.txt` | File list, printing, privacy, support. | If something doesn't work. |

## A proposal in five minutes

1. **Open proposal-builder.html** and fill in **My profile**: name, business, email, website, currency. Pick a brand colour and add your logo.
2. **Load an example** from the top bar that matches your field. It fills all nine sections with a complete proposal you can edit.
3. **Replace the client details** in section 01: project name, client, dates and the client's goal in their own words.
4. **Set your three prices** and the deposit % in section 06. Deposits, balances and dates are calculated for you.
5. **Click Print / Save as PDF**, choose Letter or A4, then send it with Email 1 from the Follow-up emails panel.

**Tip:** Save each proposal (Saved, up to 20) before loading another example. Loading a preset replaces the proposal you are editing; your profile, colour and logo stay.

# The builder at a glance




Real screen, Design preset loaded. Editor on the left, live preview of the printed proposal on the right.

### TOP BAR

- **Load an example**: 5 complete presets (Design, Web/Shopify, Copywriting, Marketing, Consulting).
- **Saved (n/20)**: save, load, duplicate or delete up to 20 proposals.
- **Export JSON / Import JSON**: back up everything (profile, logo, saved proposals) or move to another computer.
- **Letter | A4** and **Print / Save as PDF**: page 1 is always the Decision Summary on its own page.

### ABOVE THE PREVIEW

- **Copy as plain text**: the whole proposal numbered 1 to 9, ready to paste into an email.
- **Copy short pitch**: a version of 150 words or fewer for Upwork or a quick reply. The button shows the word count.

### BELOW

- **Snippet Library**: 60 ready paragraphs, filter by field and section, click Insert.
- **Follow-up emails**: 8 emails filled in with your client's name, project, price and dates. One Copy button each.

### PRINTING AND PRIVACY

Print from Chrome or Edge to get your logo in the header of every page and "Page x of y" in the footer. Everything you type stays in your browser's local storage. Nothing is uploaded.

CHAPTER 02

# Why proposals lose

Clients don't read proposals. They scan them, in a predictable order.



A client comparing freelancers may have several proposals open at once. Plan for a quick scan in three steps.



**1 · The first line.** Does this person understand what I want? If the first line is about you ("I'm a passionate designer..."), the answer is no.

**2 · The numbers.** How much, how long, when do we start? If they have to hunt for the price, they stop hunting.

**3 · The length.** Can I decide from page 1, or do I need an hour? Long is fine when page 1 already answers the question.

## Three ways good freelancers lose

### 1. THE PROPOSAL IS ABOUT YOU

Years of experience, tools and passion come first, and the client's goal comes on page 3. Fix: open with their goal, in their words (Chapter 4).

### 2. ONE PRICE, TAKE IT OR LEAVE IT

A single number invites one of two answers: yes, or "can you do it for less?" Three options change the question to "which one?" (Chapter 6).

### 3. IT LOOKS LIKE A TEMPLATE

Generic phrases ("tailored solutions", "your vision") tell the client nothing was written for them. A template is fine; leaving it generic is not. Replace every sentence that could be sent to any client.

## The fix, in one page

This builder puts a **Decision Summary** on page 1: their goal, your recommended option and price, start date, validity and three steps to say yes. Everything else supports that page. If the client reads only page 1, they can still say yes.

> `Scan test: cover everything below page 1.`
> Can a stranger tell what the client wants, what you recommend, what it costs and how to say yes? If not, fix page 1 before anything else.

CHAPTER 03

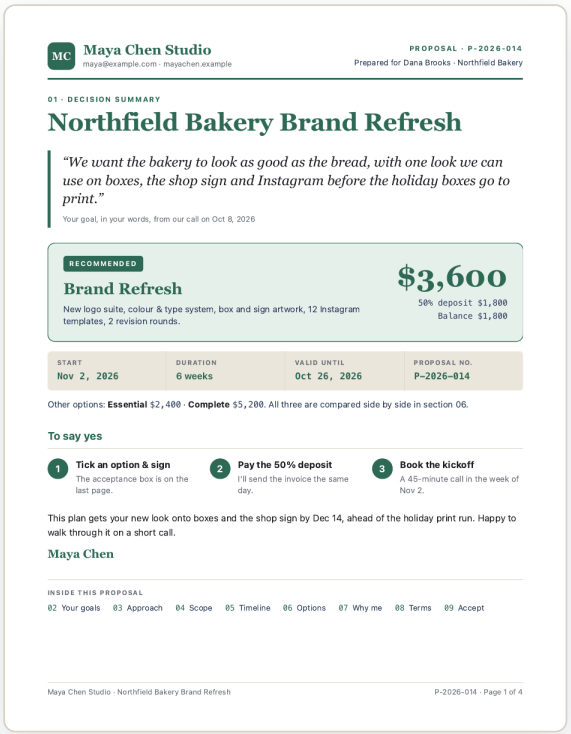
# The 1-Page Decision Summary

Seven blocks. About 150 words. One decision.



## The seven blocks

1. **Project name** as the title. Use the client's name for it, not yours.
2. **Goal quote**: one or two sentences the client said, with where you heard it.
3. **Recommended card**: option name, one line of contents, price, deposit and balance.
4. **Key facts**: start date, duration, valid until, proposal number.
5. **Other options**: the other two prices in one line.
6. **To say yes**: tick and sign, pay the deposit, book the kickoff.
7. **Closing line**: when they get the result, plus an offer to talk.



MC Maya Chen Studio
maya@example.com · mayachen.example

PROPOSAL · P-2026-014
Prepared for Dana Brooks · Northfield Bakery

01 · DECISION SUMMARY

Northfield Bakery Brand Refresh

*"We want the bakery to look as good as the bread, with one look we can use on boxes, the shop sign and Instagram before the holiday boxes go to print."*

Your goal, in your words, from our call on Oct 8, 2026

RECOMMENDED

Brand Refresh

New logo suite, colour & type system, box and sign artwork, 12 Instagram templates, 2 revision rounds.

$3,600

50% deposit $1,800
Balance $1,800

| START | DURATION | VALID UNTIL | PROPOSAL NO. |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nov 2, 2026 | 6 weeks | Oct 26, 2026 | P-2026-014 |

Other options: **Essential** $2,400 · **Complete** $5,200. All three are compared side by side in section 06.

To say yes

1 Tick an option & sign — The acceptance box is on the last page.
2 Pay the 50% deposit — I'll send the invoice the same day.
3 Book the kickoff — A 45-minute call in the week of Nov 2.

This plan gets your new look onto boxes and the shop sign by Dec 14, ahead of the holiday print run. Happy to walk through it on a short call.

Maya Chen

INSIDE THIS PROPOSAL

02 Your goals 03 Approach 04 Scope 05 Timeline 06 Options 07 Why me 08 Terms 09 Accept

Maya Chen Studio · Northfield Bakery Brand Refresh — P-2026-014 · Page 1 of 4

Real page 1 printed from the builder (Design preset, forest brand colour and example logo).

### WORD BUDGET

| Block | Aim for |
|---|---|
| Goal quote | 20–35 words |
| Recommended contents line | 12–20 words |
| Closing line | 15–30 words |
| Whole page (builder counts it) | under 250; about 150 is ideal |

The builder shows a yellow warning if the summary passes 250 words, because the page will no longer fit.

## Writing each block

### RECOMMENDED CARD

Recommend one option, out loud. "Here are three, you choose" sounds polite but makes the client do your job. Name the option after the outcome ("Brand Refresh", "Launch Store") rather than "Package B".

### KEY FACTS

A start date makes the project real. A validity date gives a reason to decide this week. Both are calculated from the dates you enter: valid until = date sent + days valid.

### TO SAY YES

Three steps, each one an action. Remove every step that isn't needed. If you need a signed agreement too, say it in step 1 ("tick, sign and I'll send the agreement").

### CLOSING LINE

Tie the date to their goal: "gets your new look onto boxes by Dec 14, ahead of the holiday print run". Then offer a short call. No "Looking forward to hearing from you!"

**EXAMPLE** `CONSULTING` **SUMMARY OPENING**

✕ **BEFORE**

Thank you for the opportunity to submit this proposal. Kovac Operations is a boutique consultancy with a proven methodology for operational excellence.

✓ **AFTER**

"Orders get stuck between sales and the warehouse, and nobody can say where." Recommended: Review + Plan, $3,500, ranked fix list by Dec 14.

→ **Why it works:** the first thing the COO reads is his own problem, then the number and the date.

### CHECKLIST FOR PAGE 1

- The first words are the client's goal, not your name.
- One option is clearly recommended, with its price.
- Deposit and balance are visible without turning the page.
- There is a start date and a valid-until date.
- A stranger could say yes using only this page.

CHAPTER 04

# Goals in the client's words

Quote them. Clients trust their own sentences more than yours.





## Ask these on the call, and write the answers down word for word

1. What made you look for help now, rather than six months ago?
2. If this goes well, what is different in three months?
3. What has to be true by a certain date? Why that date?
4. Who else will read this proposal before you decide?
5. What have you tried already, and what didn't work?
6. What would make you say no to a proposal?

Keep their exact phrases: "look as good as the bread", "nobody can say where". Those phrases go into your goal quote and the bold start of each goal bullet.

## The goal quote

Pick one or two sentences, 20 to 35 words. Trim filler, but keep their words. Add the source line: "Your goal, in your words, from our call on Oct 8, 2026". If you only have an email, quote the email.

## Goal bullets (section 02)

Up to five. Each starts with a bold client phrase, followed by what it means for the project in plain words. If a goal doesn't change your scope, price or timeline, leave it out.

**EXAMPLE** **MARKETING** **GOALS**

✕ **BEFORE**

Increase engagement and grow your brand across all channels with a data-driven email strategy.

✓ **AFTER**

**Sales between launches.** Orders spike at launches and drop in between. Email should bring steady orders in the quiet weeks.

→ **Why it works:** "engagement" belongs to every proposal; "sales between launches" belongs only to this client.

CHAPTER 05

# Scope: Included / Not included



The Not-included list is the line you point at later.



## Rules for the Included list

- Count things: "12 Instagram templates", "up to 60 products", "2 revision rounds".
- Name the deliverable, not the activity: "Brand guidelines PDF (12 pages)" beats "brand strategy".
- Put revision rounds in scope. Unlimited revisions is unlimited work.

## Rules for the Not included list

- List what this client is likely to ask for next: the neighbour of what you are doing.
- Add "(I can quote it separately)" or "(available as a monthly plan)" so it reads as an option, not a refusal.
- At least one item. The builder asks you to add one before printing.

**✓ INCLUDED · WEB DEV**

Theme setup and styling · Import of up to 60 products · 3 payment methods and shipping for 2 zones · 30 days of launch support

**✕ NOT INCLUDED · WEB DEV**

Product photography · Custom apps or paid app subscriptions · Writing product descriptions · Ongoing support after 30 days

### TYPICAL NOT-INCLUDED ITEMS BY FIELD

| Field | Worth listing as not included |
|---|---|
| Design | Website, printing and print management, photography, taglines |
| Web dev | Apps and subscriptions, content entry, photography, support after launch |
| Copywriting | Uploading copy, blog posts, emails and ads, design |
| Marketing | Ad spend and platform fees, ongoing sending, photography |
| Consulting | Software implementation, HR, legal, tax or financial advice |

### EXAMPLE WEB DEV SCOPE

**✕ BEFORE**

Build a Shopify store with all the features you need.

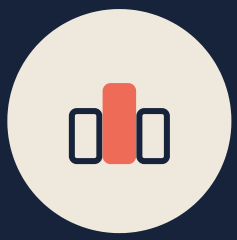
**✓ AFTER**

Included: theme setup, 60 products imported, 3 payment methods. **Not included:** photography, custom apps, support after 30 days.

CHAPTER 06

# Three options

Essential, Recommended, Complete. One question: which one?





## What each option is for

| Option | Job | How to build it |
|---|---|---|
| **Essential** | The smallest version that still reaches the goal. | Remove extras, keep the core result. Fewer rounds, shorter timeline. |
| **Recommended** | What you would do if it were your business. | The full answer to their stated goal. Price it at your real rate. |
| **Complete** | The ambitious version for a client who wants more. | Add the next result they will want (more volume, support, reporting). |

### PRICE SPACING

In the five examples, Recommended is 1.4 to 1.75 times Essential, and Complete is 1.38 to 1.46 times Recommended. Wide enough that each step buys something visible; close enough that stepping up feels reasonable.

```
Design · Recommended: 3,600 × 50% = 1,800 · balance 3,600 - 1,800 = 1,800
Web dev · Recommended: 5,600 × 40% = 2,240 · balance 5,600 - 2,240 = 3,360
```

**Deposit + balance = price, every time.**

### THE FIVE EXAMPLES IN THE BUILDER

| Field · example | Essential | Recommended | Complete | Deposit | Rec. deposit + balance |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Design** · Northfield Bakery | $2,400 | $3,600 | $5,200 | 50% | $1,800 + $1,800 |
| **Web dev** · Harbor & Pine | $3,800 | $5,600 | $8,200 | 40% | $2,240 + $3,360 |
| **Copywriting** · Clearwater Physio | $1,500 | $2,250 | $3,100 | 50% | $1,125 + $1,125 |
| **Marketing** · Little Fern Toys | $1,800 | $2,700 | $3,900 | 50% | $1,350 + $1,350 |
| **Consulting** · Brightline Logistics | $2,000 | $3,500 | $5,000 | 50% | $1,750 + $1,750 |

Generated from the presets in proposal-builder.html. The builder rounds deposits to whole amounts and calculates the balance as price minus deposit.

## Rows that make the difference visible

The Options table shows the same rows for all three options. Each row is either the same everywhere (✓ ✓ ✓, builds trust) or different (— ✓ ✓, or 1 / 2 / 3, gives a reason to step up). Aim for 6 to 8 rows, and always include **Revision rounds** and **Timeline**.

**EXAMPLE** `COPYWRITING` **PRICE**

✕ **BEFORE**

My fee for the website copy is $2,250.

✓ **AFTER**

Essential $1,500 (copy only) · **Copy + SEO $2,250** (recommended) · Complete $3,100 (copy, SEO and 2 patient interviews).

→ **Why it works:** one price invites "can you do it for less?"; three options turn it into "which one?".

## Add-ons (up to 4)

Small, priced extras that sit outside all three options: an extra page, a gift card design, a monthly care plan. They answer "can you also..." before it is asked, with a price attached.

## Find 5 reference prices in 15 minutes

If you are unsure where to set Recommended, collect five prices for similar work before you decide:

1. **Freelance marketplaces** (e.g. Upwork, Fiverr Pro): search your service and note 2 fixed prices from profiles with real reviews.
2. **Peer websites**: find 2 freelancers or small studios in your field who publish prices or "projects start at".
3. **A rate survey for your field** (industry association or community survey): note 1 typical day or project rate.
4. Write the five numbers in a row, sorted. The middle one is the **median**.
5. Set **Recommended** at or above the median if your proof (section 07) is strong; set Essential below it and Complete above it.

Write the five prices and the median on the planning worksheet (Chapter 11, "Reference prices" row) so you can defend your number later.

CHAPTER 07

# Terms that protect you

Short, plain terms that settle payment, rounds and delays before they start.





## The six terms

| Term | Default wording in the builder |
|---|---|
| **Deposit** | 50% deposit to book your start date. (The Web dev example uses 40%.) |
| **Payment timing** | The balance is due within 7 days of the final delivery date in the timeline. |
| **Revision rounds** | Rounds as listed in your option. Extra rounds at $[rate]/hour, quoted before work starts. |
| **Late materials** | If materials from you arrive late, the timeline moves by the same number of days; the final payment stays due on the original date. |
| **Validity** | Valid until [date] (14 days from the date sent). |
| **Change requests** | New requests get a short written change note with price and date before any work starts. |

### WHY THE LATE-MATERIALS CLAUSE MATTERS

Projects can stall while you wait for the client: photos, logins, feedback, product data. Without this clause, a two-week wait for photos can push your final payment back by two weeks too. With it, the delivery date moves, but the balance stays due on the date in the original timeline. Every example in the builder and in proposal-templates.md includes it.

```
Timeline final delivery: Dec 14 · balance due within 7 days: by Dec 21
Photos arrive 5 days late → delivery moves to Dec 19 · balance still due by Dec 21
```

ⓘ **Not legal advice. A proposal is not a contract.** These terms set expectations. Section 09 of every proposal says "This proposal is not a contract" and promises a short agreement after acceptance. Check your agreement with a professional where you work.

## Saying the terms out loud

Clients accept terms they understand. On the call, before you send the proposal, say each one in a sentence:

- **Deposit:** "The deposit books your start date. Until it's paid, I can't hold the slot."
- **Rounds:** "Your option includes two rounds. If we need a third, I'll quote it first."
- **Late materials:** "If the photos come late, the delivery moves by the same days, but the final invoice date doesn't."
- **Validity:** "The proposal is valid for 14 days because I plan my calendar around it."

## Change requests in three steps

1. **Acknowledge** the request the same day: "Good idea. It's outside the current scope, so I'll send a change note."
2. **Send a change note**: what changes, price, new dates. One paragraph.
3. **Start only after a written yes.** Add the note to the project file.

**Change note template**

```
Change [number] for [Project Name]: [what is added or changed]. Price: [amount].
Timeline: [new date or "no change"]. Reply "yes" and I'll start on [date].
```

## Deposits and payment points

For projects up to about 6 weeks, deposit plus balance is enough. For longer projects (like the 13-week Complete option in the Consulting example), split the balance into payment points tied to milestones in your agreement, and keep the deposit the same.

### WHAT NOT TO PUT IN A PROPOSAL

- Long legal clauses copied from a contract template. Keep them for the agreement.
- Late-payment penalties as the first thing the client reads. Put clear dates instead.
- "Unlimited revisions" or "until you're happy".

CHAPTER 08

# Follow-up schedule

Four short emails after sending, three replies for the hard answers.








| # | Email | When | Subject line |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Sending the proposal** | Day 0 | `Proposal: [Project Name]` |
| 2 | **Day 2 check-in** | Day 2 | `Quick check on the [Project Name] proposal` |
| 3 | **Day 5 value add** | Day 5 | `One idea for [Project Name]` |
| 4 | **Day 10 decision nudge** | Day 10 | `[Project Name]: still a priority?` |
| 5 | **1 day before the proposal expires** | 1 day before expiry | `Your [Project Name] proposal expires tomorrow` |
| 6 | **Reply to "It's more than we expected"** | Reply | `Re: [Project Name] proposal` |
| 7 | **Reply to "We need to think about it"** | Reply | `Re: [Project Name] proposal` |
| 8 | **Reply to "We went with someone else"** | Reply | `Re: [Project Name] proposal` |

## RULES

- Each email asks for one small thing: a question, a call, a decision.
- Day 5 gives something useful even if they never hire you.
- The day-before-expiry email is real: if they don't answer, release the date.
- Stop after the expiry email. If they come back later, update the dates and send a new proposal.

The builder fills in the client's first name, project name, recommended option and price, valid-until date, start date and your name. Text in grey brackets, such as [Time option 1], is yours to write.

CHAPTER 09

# 5 annotated example proposals

One per field. The numbered notes explain why each part is written that way.



## Design · Northfield Bakery Brand Refresh

**Maya Chen Studio** PROPOSAL · P-2026-014

### Northfield Bakery Brand Refresh

> *"We want the bakery to look as good as the bread, with one look we can use on boxes, the shop sign and Instagram before the holiday boxes go to print."* 1

RECOMMENDED
**Brand Refresh** 2 — **$3,600**
50% $1,800 · bal. $1,800

NOT INCLUDED 3

- Website design or build
- Packaging print management
- Photography
- Copywriting / tagline

OPTIONS 4

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Essential | $2,400 | dep. $1,200 | bal. $1,200 |
| Brand Refresh | $3,600 | dep. $1,800 | bal. $1,800 |
| Complete | $5,200 | dep. $2,600 | bal. $2,600 |

TIMELINE & TERMS 5

Start Nov 2, 2026 · Final files & guidelines (Week +6) Dec 14, 2026. 50% deposit to book your start date. The balance is due within 7 days of the final delivery date in the timeline. *If materials from you arrive late, the timeline moves by the same number of days; the final payment stays due on the original date.*

1 The quote uses Dana's own image ("as good as the bread") and her deadline (holiday boxes). She recognises her words immediately.

2 The middle option is named after the outcome, not "Standard". The name reappears on page 1 and in the emails.

3 Website, print management and photography are what a bakery asks a designer for next. Listing them now prevents "can you just..." later.

4 Essential still delivers a usable logo system; Complete adds more templates and a longer guidelines PDF. Each step buys something visible.

5 Final files land Dec 14, ahead of the print run the client mentioned. The late-materials clause protects the payment date if photos or approvals slip.

# Web / Shopify development · Harbor & Pine Shopify Store

**Marsh Web Works** PROPOSAL · P-2026-021

## Harbor & Pine Shopify Store

> *"We sell at markets and through Instagram messages. We need a proper store where people can buy without messaging us, live before our spring collection drops in mid-January."* 1

RECOMMENDED
**Launch Store** 2 — **$5,600**
40% $2,240 · bal. $3,360

NOT INCLUDED 3

- Product photography or photo editing
- Custom apps or paid app subscriptions
- Writing product descriptions
- Ongoing support after 30 days (available as a monthly plan)

OPTIONS 4

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Essential | $3,800 | dep. $1,520 | bal. $2,280 |
| Launch Store | $5,600 | dep. $2,240 | bal. $3,360 |
| Complete | $8,200 | dep. $3,280 | bal. $4,920 |

TIMELINE & TERMS 5

Start Nov 9, 2026 · Launch & training (Week +8) Jan 4, 2027. 40% deposit to book your start date. The balance is due within 7 days of the launch date in the timeline. *If materials from you arrive late, the timeline moves by the same number of days; the final payment stays due on the original date.*

1 Sam's real problem is orders arriving by message. A technical proposal would start with the theme; this one starts with checkout working "without messaging us".

2 "Launch Store" tells a non-technical founder what they get. Numbers in the contents (60 products, 2 zones) make it checkable.

3 Photography, apps and product descriptions are the usual scope creep in store builds. Support after 30 days is offered as a monthly plan.

4 A 40% deposit keeps the first invoice lower on a larger project; balances are still calculated automatically.

5 Launch on Jan 4, before the mid-January collection. The balance is tied to the launch date in the timeline, not the actual go-live day.

# Copywriting · Clearwater Physio Website Copy

**Priya Nair Copy** PROPOSAL · P-2026-008

## Clearwater Physio Website Copy

> *"People find us on Google, read the site and still call to ask what we do. We want pages that answer their questions and get them to book online."* 1

RECOMMENDED
**Copy + SEO** 2
**$2,250**
50% $1,125 · bal. $1,125

NOT INCLUDED 3

- Website design or uploading the copy to your site
- Blog posts
- Photography
- Paid ads

OPTIONS 4

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Essential | $1,500 | dep. $750 | bal. $750 |
| Copy + SEO | $2,250 | dep. $1,125 | bal. $1,125 |
| Complete | $3,100 | dep. $1,550 | bal. $1,550 |

TIMELINE & TERMS 5

Start Nov 2, 2026 · Final copy (Week +4) Nov 30, 2026. 50% deposit to book your start date. The balance is due within 7 days of the final copy date in the timeline. *If materials from you arrive late, the timeline moves by the same number of days; the final payment stays due on the original date.*

1 "Still call to ask what we do" is a measurable pain: fewer calls, more online bookings. Every page plan points back to it.

2 "Copy + SEO" makes the difference with Essential obvious: same 5 pages, plus being found on Google.

3 Writers lose time uploading copy into site builders. Saying so up front keeps the job to writing.

4 Complete adds patient interviews: real phrases from real patients. A clear reason to pay more, not just "more pages".

5 Four weeks with dated milestones. Late feedback moves the delivery, not the payment date.

# Marketing · Little Fern Toys Email Marketing Setup

**Reyes Email Studio** PROPOSAL · P-2026-017

## Little Fern Toys Email Marketing Setup

> *"We have 3,000 subscribers and only send an email when we remember. We want emails that go out on their own and bring in sales between launches."* 1

RECOMMENDED
**Automated Setup** 2 — **$2,700**
50% $1,350 · bal. $1,350

NOT INCLUDED 3

- Paid ads or social media management
- Product photography
- Email platform subscription fees
- Sending weekly campaigns after launch (available as a retainer)

OPTIONS 4

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Essential | $1,800 | dep. $900 | bal. $900 |
| Automated Setup | $2,700 | dep. $1,350 | bal. $1,350 |
| Complete | $3,900 | dep. $1,950 | bal. $1,950 |

TIMELINE & TERMS 5

Start Nov 2, 2026 · 1-week results check (Week +5) Dec 7, 2026. 50% deposit to book your start date. The balance is due within 7 days of the launch date in the timeline. *If materials from you arrive late, the timeline moves by the same number of days; the final payment stays due on the original date.*

1 "Only send an email when we remember" is honest and specific. Jess will share this with her co-founder, so page 1 has to stand alone.

2 "Automated Setup" names the result: emails that send themselves. The contents line lists the three flows by name.

3 Ad spend and platform fees are outside your control. Ongoing sending is offered as a retainer, which can become the next project.

4 Complete adds three months of reports, the thing the co-founder wanted. It turns a goal from the call into a paid option.

5 Flows go live Nov 30, before holiday shopping. No sales figure is promised; results are reported instead.

# Consulting · Brightline Logistics Operations Process Review

**Kovac Operations** PROPOSAL · P-2026-011

## Brightline Logistics Operations Process Review

> *"Orders get stuck between sales and the warehouse, and nobody can say where. We want a clear process and someone to tell us what to fix first."* 1

RECOMMENDED
**Review + Plan** 2 — **$3,500**
50% $1,750 · bal. $1,750

NOT INCLUDED 3

- Software selection or implementation
- Hiring or HR decisions
- Legal, tax or financial advice
- Hands-on management of the fixes (Complete adds 4 check-ins)

OPTIONS 4

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Essential | $2,000 | dep. $1,000 | bal. $1,000 |
| Review + Plan | $3,500 | dep. $1,750 | bal. $1,750 |
| Complete | $5,000 | dep. $2,500 | bal. $2,500 |

TIMELINE & TERMS 5

Start Nov 9, 2026 · Leadership workshop (Week +5) Dec 14, 2026. 50% deposit to book your start date. The balance is due within 7 days of the workshop date in the timeline. *If materials from you arrive late, the timeline moves by the same number of days; the final payment stays due on the original date.*

1 A COO wants the problem named in one line. "Nobody can say where" also explains why an outside review is worth paying for.

2 "Review + Plan" separates the diagnosis from the fix plan, so the client sees exactly what the extra $1,500 over Essential buys.

3 Software, HR and legal advice are common asks in operations work. Excluding them keeps you inside your expertise.

4 Complete runs 13 weeks because it adds four check-ins every two weeks. Longer timelines are a reason to agree payment points in the agreement.

5 The workshop date is the anchor for the balance. If data arrives late, the workshop moves; the payment date does not.

CHAPTER 10

# Before / After

Six rewrites across five fields. Same project, same price, clearer words.



Read the left card, then the right. Each rewrite moves one thing: the client's goal first, a number they can check, or a line that protects your scope.



**PAIR 01** DESIGN **OPENING LINE**

✕ BEFORE

Hi! I'm a passionate designer with 4 years of experience and I'd love to help you with your branding.

✓ AFTER

You want one look you can use on boxes, the sign and Instagram before the holiday print run. Here's a 6-week plan for $3,600.

→ **Why it works:** the first line is their goal and the second is the number they scan for.

**PAIR 02** WEB DEV **SCOPE**

✕ BEFORE

Build a Shopify store with all the features you need.

✓ AFTER

Included: theme setup, 60 products imported, 3 payment methods. **Not included:** product photography, custom apps, ongoing support after 30 days.

→ **Why it works:** "all the features" has no edge. A Not-included list gives you one to point at later.

**PAIR 03** COPYWRITING **PRICE**

✕ BEFORE

My fee for the website copy is $2,250.

✓ AFTER

Essential $1,500 (copy only) · **Copy + SEO $2,250** · Complete $3,100 (copy, SEO and 2 patient interviews).

→ **Why it works:** one price invites "can you do it for less?"; three options turn it into "which one?".

**PAIR 04** MARKETING **SUMMARY**

✕ **BEFORE**

We offer comprehensive email marketing solutions to take your brand to the next level, tailored to your unique needs.

✓ **AFTER**

Welcome, abandoned-cart and post-purchase emails live by Nov 30, so orders keep coming between launches. Recommended: $2,700.

→ **Why it works:** named flows, a date and a price replace three phrases that fit any agency.

**PAIR 05** CONSULTING **GOAL**

✕ **BEFORE**

Objective: optimise operational efficiency and drive continuous improvement across the organisation.

✓ **AFTER**

**Know what to fix first.** A short, ranked list of fixes rather than a 60-page report.

→ **Why it works:** it repeats what the COO asked for and promises a format he can act on.

**PAIR 06** DESIGN **TERMS**

✕ **BEFORE**

Timeline depends on client feedback. Payment due upon completion.

✓ **AFTER**

If materials from you arrive late, the timeline moves by the same number of days; the final payment stays due on the original date.

→ **Why it works:** "upon completion" lets a slow client delay your payment. A fixed date doesn't.

**The pattern behind all six**

- Their words before yours.
- A number, a date or a count in every key sentence.
- An edge: what's not included, what happens if something is late.
- Delete any sentence you could send to a different client unchanged.

CHAPTER 11

# Pre-send checklist

Print this page. Tick every box before you press send.





### PAGE 1 · DECISION SUMMARY

- [ ] First words are the client's goal, in their words
- [ ] One option is recommended, with price
- [ ] Deposit and balance are shown
- [ ] Start date and valid-until date are correct
- [ ] Summary is under 250 words

### GOALS · APPROACH · SCOPE

- [ ] Every goal changes scope, price or timing
- [ ] 3 to 6 approach steps, one line each
- [ ] Included items are counted
- [ ] At least one Not-included item

### TIMELINE · OPTIONS

- [ ] Milestone dates match the start date
- [ ] Revision rounds and timeline rows filled in
- [ ] Deposit + balance = price for all three
- [ ] Add-ons have prices

### WHY ME · TERMS · ACCEPT

- [ ] Proof is real and checkable (no example text left)
- [ ] Late-materials clause is included
- [ ] Your email is in the acceptance section
- [ ] "Not a contract" line is in place

### BEFORE YOU SEND

- [ ] No [Brackets] left anywhere
- [ ] Client name spelled correctly everywhere
- [ ] PDF saved and opened once to check
- [ ] Follow-ups for Day 2, 5 and 10 in your calendar

# Proposal planning worksheet

Fill this in during or right after the discovery call. One worksheet per proposal.

| CLIENT | PROJECT | DATE OF CALL |
| --- | --- | --- |
| | | |

## GOAL IN THEIR WORDS (EXACT PHRASES)

## DEADLINE AND WHY

## WHO ELSE DECIDES

## INCLUDED / NOT INCLUDED

| ✓ | × |
| --- | --- |
| ✓ | × |
| ✓ | × |

## THREE OPTIONS

| ESSENTIAL $ | RECOMMENDED $ | COMPLETE $ |
| --- | --- | --- |
| WEEKS | WEEKS | WEEKS |

## REFERENCE PRICES (5) AND MEDIAN

## START DATE · VALID UNTIL · DEPOSIT %

# Quick reference

### THE CALCULATIONS THE BUILDER DOES FOR YOU

| Value | Formula | Design example |
|---|---|---|
| Deposit | `price × deposit %` | `3,600 × 50% = 1,800` |
| Balance | `price - deposit` | `3,600 - 1,800 = 1,800` |
| Milestone date | `start + N × 7 days` | `Nov 2 + 6 weeks = Dec 14` |
| Valid until | `date sent + days valid` | `Oct 12 + 14 days = Oct 26` |

### THE NINE SECTIONS, IN ORDER

| # | Section | One-line job |
|---|---|---|
| 01 | Decision summary | Everything needed to say yes, on one page |
| 02 | Your goals | Up to 5 goals, each starting with their phrase |
| 03 | Approach | 3 to 6 steps, one line each |
| 04 | Scope | Included and Not included |
| 05 | Timeline | Up to 8 milestones with dates |
| 06 | Options | Three options, deposits, add-ons |
| 07 | Why me | 2 to 3 real, checkable proofs |
| 08 | Terms | Payments, rounds, changes, validity, late materials |
| 09 | Next steps & acceptance | Tick boxes, signature lines, "not a contract" |

Sections 02 to 08 can be switched off in the builder; 01 and 09 are always included. Numbers update automatically.

Questions or a problem with a file? Email **chenphien@gmail.com**. Refunds within 14 days of purchase, no questions asked.